



*When the Past
Chose Love*

written by

Gopinath .R

Chapter 1 – The Question

One night, one small boy sat on the floor and played with his toy car.
The door opened.

The boy say, “Mamaaa... why are you late?” with a smile.

Mama laugh and says, “Sorry da, your Appa is the reason. I have something for you.”

Mama put his hand inside the bag, take a new toy car, and give it to the boy.

The boy very happy.

At that time, one little girl come and ask, “Mama, where is my gift?”

Mama say, “Aaah... I have a big gift for you.”
He take a Barbie toy kit and give her.

The little girl very happy and run inside the house and shout,
“Ammaaaa, Mama buy a Barbie toy for me!”

Mama face becomes bright. That was his real smile.

That time Sri come near Mama and put his hand on his shoulder and say,
“Hey little boy, why are you crying?”

Mama eyes fill with water, but he controls it and say,
“No no, I am not crying. I am very happy.”

Sri slowly go to the kitchen to take water.
He stand there for few seconds and smile quietly.

The boy come and sit near Mama.
He swing his legs, holding the new toy car.

The boy ask, “Mama, why we don’t go to Appa’s old house?”

Mama not answer immediately.
He look at the boy’s face. It look like his father.

Mama say slowly, “Because some houses are left behind so lives can move forward.”

The boy ask again, “Did Appa leave because he was angry?”

Mama shake his head and say, “No. Your Appa left because he loved someone more than himself.”

The boy become curious and say, “Oooh... who are they?”

Mama smile and say, “You all.”

The boy say, “What Appa do in his past?”

Mama take a deep breath and say, “His past is a cinema.”

The boy smile and say, “I am very interested to hear.”

Mama look at the night and start to tell the story.
And that was where the past begin.



Chapter 2 – The First Meeting (16/12/2023)

your father Sri is a final year B.Sc Computer Science student.
He is innocent, introvert, and very strong in tech.
He have only few friends in college.

your mother Maya is a first year B.Sc Computer Science student.
She is extrovert, foodie, and always smiling.
She have many friends and enjoy college life.

That day college conduct a Project Expo event.

Sri is the tech support for that event.
He sit in one chair and play chess in his mobile.

Maya come with her team. Her team have four members.

They start their project.
But suddenly the project show one error in the screen.

Maya's team became tense.

They call one staff for help.

The staff check the laptop for ten minutes.
He make some changes and save the project.

When he run the project again, nothing work.

The staff become fear because it is a state level event and only three hours left.

The staff call Sri and say, "Sri, please come fast. The project show error. I cannot find the mistake."
Sri pick the call and say, "Okay sir, I am coming."
Sri go to their room and ask, "What happened sir?"

The staff show the laptop.

Sri sit and start to check the code.
While fixing, Sri ask about the project idea.
Maya explain the project with fear and hope.

Sri find the error and solve it within twenty five minutes.
The project run successfully.

All team members look at Sri like a hero.
Sri say,
"This project is good. But you need to add more features to make it best. Think more ideas and improve it."

One boy in the team say, "Anna, we are not good in coding."





Sri remember his past.
When he was first year student, he asked help from others and they laugh at him.

Sri look at Maya and say, “Give me your laptop.”

Maya give her laptop.

Sri use AI and his skills and work for two hours.
He add more features and upgrade the project.
Then Sri explain every function to the team.

At that time Sri phone ring.
One staff call and say, “Come fast, the projector is not working.”

Sri say to Maya team, “I want to go now.”

Maya team say together, “Thanks naa.”

Sri smile and go to the main hall.
The event start.

Many teams present their projects.
Sri help in technical side everywhere.
Judges come and announce the result.

“The first prize goes to Maya’s team.”

Maya team shout in happiness.

Sri hear this from far place.
His face become happy and a small smile come.
After the event, Maya team search for Sri everywhere.

At last they find him.
Maya say, “Thank you so much naa. Because of you only we win.”
Sri smile and say, “Do well always.”
Maya ask, “How you are so good in coding?”
Sri smile and say, “Practice and pain.”

Maya laugh.

That day Maya take Sri number.
That was the first meeting of Sri and Maya.

And slowly... their story begin.

Chapter 3 – Love Without Words

After that day, Sri and Maya start to talk often.

First only about project.

Next about college.

Then about life.

They talk in phone and message every day.

Sri college days slowly finish.

Maya still have some years.

They share their pain and past.

Sri become very close to Maya.

Maya also become very close to Sri.

But Maya heart feel something more.

She love Sri.

But she not tell him.

Because he is senior and she is junior.

She fear if she tell, the friendship will end.

Sri get a job in IT company with 35,000 salary.

College end.

But their talk not end.

Phone call.

Message.

Video call.

One day Sri birthday come.

Maya cannot control her feeling.

She want to see him and say something important.

That night, Maya come to an event that happened near Sri PG.

Maya and her friends buy cake and gift.

At exactly 12:00 AM, Maya send a message to Sri: “Happy Birthday, Sri.”

Within one minute, Sri reply, “Thank you, Maya.”

Then Maya call Sri and say, “Come down.”

Sri come down from his PG.

He see Maya standing with cake.

Sri shock and happy.

“Why you come here?” Sri ask.

Maya smile.

They cut the cake.

They laugh.

They talk.

Time go very fast.

Maya heart beat fast.

She look at Sri and say,

“I want to tell you something.

It is hard to hide.”





Sri look serious.
Maya say slowly, “I love you, Sri.”

Sri eyes open big.
For few seconds, silence.

Then Sri smile and say, “I also love you, Maya.”

Maya face become bright.

That night become special for both.
They talk till morning.

From that day, their love become strong.
Days go.
Months go.
Maya also reach end of her college life.

Love grow like small plant become big tree.
But they forget one thing...
Family.
And that is where the real fight start.

Present Time (Bridge Scene)

Sri stand in the kitchen and shout,
“aaaa both, what do you want to eat today?”

Mama character say, “Mmmm... biryani mama”

Sri laugh and say,
“Da, you are in Switzerland. Wait for ten days. You will return to India and eat biryani.”

The boy shout, “Fondue!”

Sri smile and say, “Okay, I am going out. Watch the house.”

Mama and the boy say at the same time,
“Okay.”

Sri go out from the house.

After Sri leave, silence come.
The boy look at Mama and ask, “What happened next?”
Mama smile and say, “You are very interested in your father story.”
The boy say, “Yes yes.”
Mama say, “I forget to tell you about the families.”

Then Mama start the story again.

Chapter 4 – Families Against Love

Sri family look good outside but inside they care only about money and status.
They not care about Sri happiness.

Maya family is different.
They fight always.
Her childhood was happy only because of her grandmother.

After grandmother die, Maya life become strict and dark.
No phone.
No TV.
Only school and home.
Still Maya study and become strong.

Time pass.

Sri and Maya decide to tell their love to both families.

First Sri tell in his house.
At first his family say okay.
Then they ask one question.

“What is her caste?”

Sri not want to answer.
But they force him.
Sri tell the truth.

That day Sri house become fighting house.
Only shouting.
Only words like knife.

Sri leave his own house with pain.
With help of his friend, he find a new place to stay.

On the other side, Maya tell her family.

Her father become very angry.
He beat her.
They take her mobile.
They lock her inside house.
Relatives come and scold her.
Maya heart break.

She want to say one thing only, “Sri, help me.”



In evening Sri try to call her.
No answer.

Sri mind say, “Something wrong in her house.”
Sri take his friend bike and go near her area.

He wait there for three hours.
No news.
No call.

That time Sri get one call from unknown number.
He pick the call.
Maya voice come with fear and crying, “Sri... please help me... they are beating me... please come fast...”

Suddenly door open sound come.

One man shout, “Ohh, is that your lover aa?”
Phone fall down.
Sri hear only crying sound.
Maya say, “Please leave me...”

Then someone pick the phone and cut the call.

Sri body shake.
His mind stop.
His heart burn.
Sri not think anything.
He take his friend bike and go fast.

Before this, Sri already told his friends, “If I die, everything will be fine.”
His friends fear something bad will happen.
Two friends follow Sri secretly.

Sri stop in front of one house.
His friends hide and watch him.
After some time, they feel danger and come out.

Sri go inside the house.
People sit there.
Maya mother cry.

One person ask, “Who are you?”

Sri not answer.

One small girl stand in stairs and shout,
“She is in the upper room.”



Sri run upstairs.

His two friends run behind him.

Sri open the room door.
He see Maya lying on the floor.
Her father is beating her with a belt.

Sri shout, “Stop now!”

Everyone shock.
Her father turn and look at Sri.

Sri shout again, “Stop now!”

Her father say, “Ohh, you are her lover aa? How dare you come to my house!”

Sri say with fear and anger, “I love her. If anyone hit her again, I will take bad decision.”

Her father laugh and say, “You think I am afraid aa?”

He hit her again.

Sri shout, “Stop now!”

Maya shout with pain,
“You are the worst person in my life. You are not my father. After grandmother die, my life is destroyed.”

Her father become mad and say,
“I don’t want you as my child. Go. Don’t come back.”

Maya cry.

Sri holds her hand.

They come down.

Her mother cry and say, “Don’t go.”

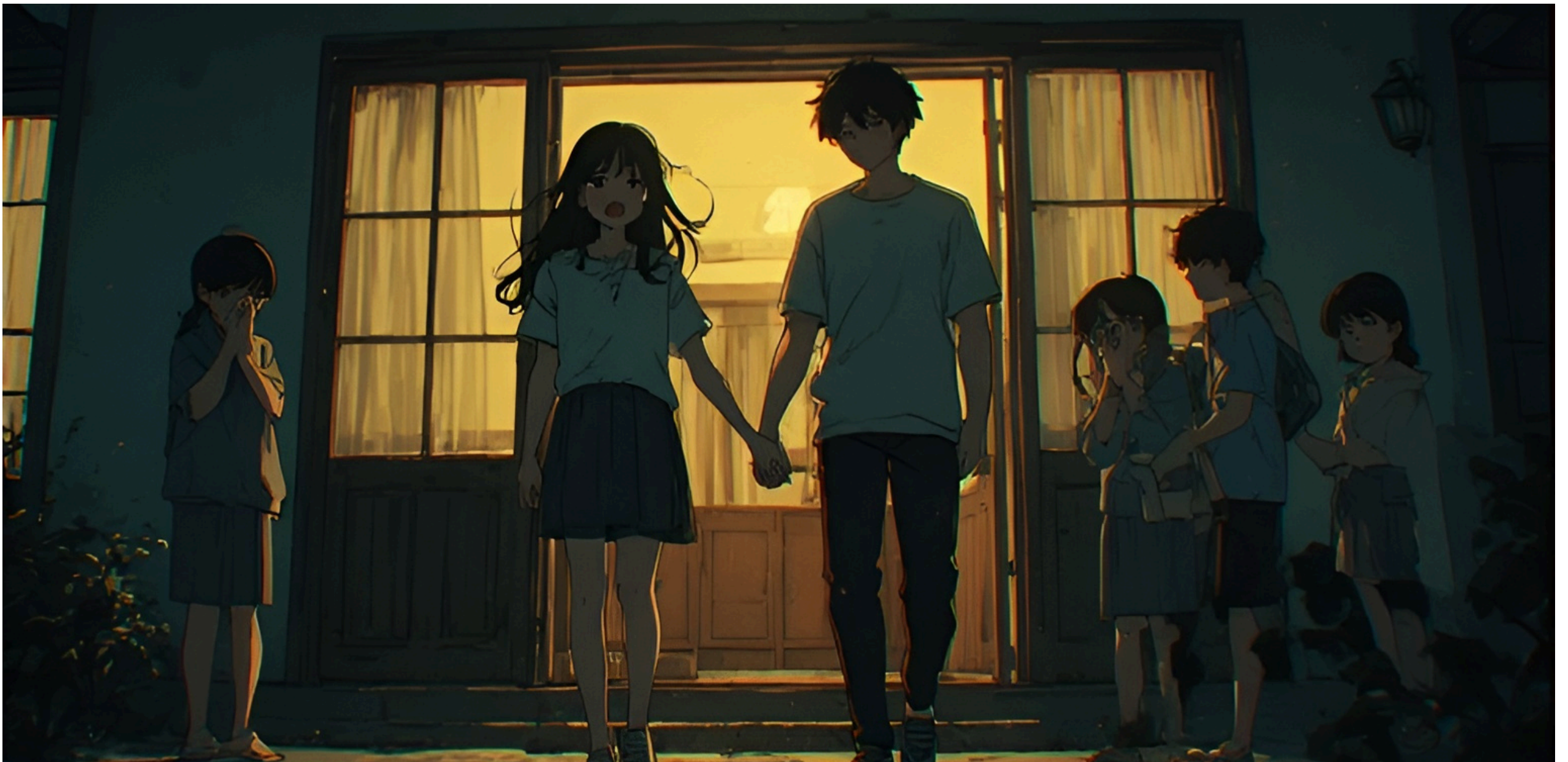
Maya say, “Sorry amma, I want to leave forever.”

Sri and Maya leave that house with two friends.

Night become long.

Road become silent.

But their life change forever.



Chapter 5 – A New Home

After leaving Maya’s house, Sri and Maya go with two friends.

One friend says, “Macha, I know one place. You can stay there for a few days.”

They reach a small rental house.

The house owner opens the door and looks at them.

He looks at Sri’s friend and smiles.

The owner says, “Hello, my boy... how are you?”

Sri’s friend says, “I am fine, uncle.”

The owner looks at Sri and Maya and asks, “Who are they?”

Sri’s friend says, “They are my friends, uncle.”

The owner smiles and says, “Come inside first.”

They all go inside the house.

The owner brings tea and gives it to everyone.

They sit silently for a few seconds.

Then the owner asks, “Tell me... what can I do for you?”

Sri’s friend looks at Sri.

Sri stands and says slowly, “Uncle... we need a house to stay. For both of us.”

The owner looks at their faces.

He sees fear, tiredness, and pain.

The owner asks softly, “What happened?”

Sri tells everything.

After hearing the story, the owner becomes quiet.

Then he smiles and says, “No problem, my boy. You can stay here.”

Sri says, “Uncle... advance and rent...”

The owner stops him and says, “Give later. First drink tea. This is your house now.”

Maya’s eyes become wet.

Sri bows his head with respect.



That house becomes their first home.
Small, simple, but full of hope.

Sri starts to work very hard.

He wakes early.
Goes to office.
Comes home late.
Takes care of Maya.
Takes care of the house.

Maya starts to search for a job.

Every day she goes to interviews.
Sometimes she gets rejected.
Sometimes they say,
“We will call you.”

Maya comes home tired,
but she never cries.

Sri gives her water and says,
“Don’t worry.
One day you will get a good job.”

Friends support them.
Sometimes they bring food.
Sometimes they help in the house.



After a few months, Sri and Maya get married.

No big function.
No family support.
Only friends and the house owner bless them.

Maya smiles.
Sri smiles.
Both feel happy.

One morning, Maya gets a call.
“Hello... you are selected.”

Maya’s hands shake.
Her eyes fill with tears.

She runs to Sri and says, “Sri... I got a job!”
Sri smiles and says, “I told you.”

Maya gets a job in a small IT company.
Her first salary comes.
Maya buys sweets.
She gives one sweet to Sri and says, “This is our first success.”

After that, Maya continues her job.

Sri takes care of everything at home.
He cooks.
He cleans.
He waits for her.
He also goes to office and works in a company.

Life is busy, but full of love.

Days pass.
Months pass.

One day, Maya gets a new mail from her company.
“You are selected for a job opportunity in Switzerland”

Maya reads it again and again.
She cannot believe it.
She goes to Sri and says, “Sri... they are calling me to Switzerland.”

Sri stays silent for a few seconds.
Then he smiles and says, “This is your dream. You must go.”
Maya cries and says, “But you?”
Sri holds her hand and says, “I will take care of myself. You go and build our future.”

Maya’s friend already works in the same company in Switzerland.
That friend helps her with room, food, and office work.
Maya goes to Switzerland with fear and hope.

The first days are very hard.
New place.
New language.
New life.

But her friend stands with her.
Maya works very hard there.
She sends money to Sri.

They do video calls every day.
Sometimes tears.
Sometimes smiles.
Distance makes their love stronger.

One day at Sri’s office,
one tester makes a mistake in the project.
The manager wants to blame that tester.
Sri protects that tester.

The manager becomes angry.
He gives Sri a black mark.
He removes him from the job.
Sri feels sad.
Life feels hard again.

Maya calls him.
Her voice soft but full of care,
“You are my hero. I will take care of you.”

Sri smiles.
He feels love.
He feels peace.

Sri becomes a house husband.
He takes care of the home.
Life is slow, but full of love.

One day, Maya tells Sri, “They also gave a job for you here... but in a different company.”
(She had taken his resume and searched for a job for him.)
Sri feels shocked and happy.

After some time, Sri goes to Switzerland.
New country.
Snow everywhere.
Sri smiles.
Maya cries with happiness.

Life starts again in Switzerland.



Chapter 6 – New Life in Switzerland

One day, Maya tells Sri,
“I am pregnant.”

Sri’s eyes open wide.
He holds her hands and says,
“Really? Our baby?”

Maya nods and smiles with tears.

Both feel fear and happiness at the same time.

With friends’ help, a baby boy is born. and that baby is you

That baby brings new light to their life.

Sri feels proud.
Maya feels happy.

Life is still hard.

Maya goes back to work.
Sri takes care of the home and the baby.
He cooks, cleans, plays with the baby,
and also works from home.

Days pass.
Months pass.

Even when jobs are lost...
Even when money is tight...
Even when family is far away...

Love stays.
Hope stays.
Life keeps moving forward.

Mama looks at the boy and says,
“This is how they survive.
How they build life together.
Hard work, struggle, love... everything mixed.”



Present Time –

That time, a little girl grabs Mama's mobile and shouts,
“Gopi maaaa... Gopi maaaa... phone... phone...”

Gopi laughs.

Gopi asks,
“Who is that?”

The little girl says,
“I don't know... mama. It shows only number... and Indi...”

Gopi smiles and says,
“Okay okay... it is an Indian number.”

Gopi picks the call and says,
“Hello... yaru?”

From the other side, a voice comes,
“Hello... senior.”

Gopi's face becomes happy.
A small smile appears.

Mama's story ends there.

The past holds the love.
The present builds the love.
The future searches for love.

Life may begin with pain,
but it always moves toward light.

When you find the right heart,
everything finds its place.

And that is how love becomes life.

By :
Gopinath. R